

Mark Fedenia Baird Professor of Finance

University of Wisconsin–Madison

CS620 Capstone Project · Fall 2026

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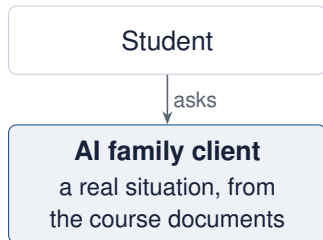
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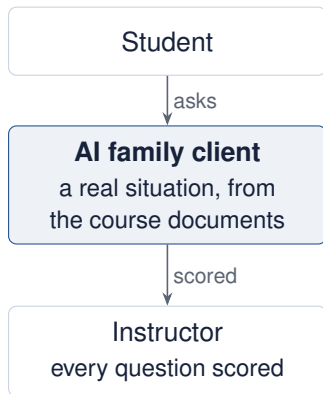
What it is

Student

What it is



What it is



How it works today

- In a browser — **Open WebUI** on a cloud machine

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- Roughly **eight containers**, one language model

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- In a browser — **Open WebUI** on a cloud machine
- Roughly **eight containers**, one language model
- The student **types**. The client types back.

It works. Students use it every week.

Two ways to make it better

- 1 Make what we have **fast** and **easy to change**.

Two ways to make it better

- 1 Make what we have **fast** and **easy to change**.
- 2 Turn the chat box into **someone you talk to**.

One: solid ground

- Get **current** with the platform, and stay current

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- Grading on **the web**, not on a laptop

One: solid ground

- Get **current** with the platform, and stay current
- Grading on **the web**, not on a laptop
- **Automatic** deployment and testing

Two: the leap

Today the student *types* a question
and *reads* an answer.

Two: the leap

Today the student *types* a question
and *reads* an answer.

We want them to say it out loud,
to a face that listens and answers back.

Why that matters

In a real meeting you get **one shot**
at the hard question, out loud,
while a family watches you.

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**You cannot practise that
with a backspace key.**

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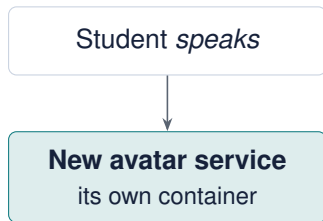
The project: evaluate, then build

- A dozen **avatar platforms**, all new, none proven here
- **Fast enough?** Under about a second to answer
- **Cheap enough?** Per student, and capped
- **Allowed?** Voice and video are student records

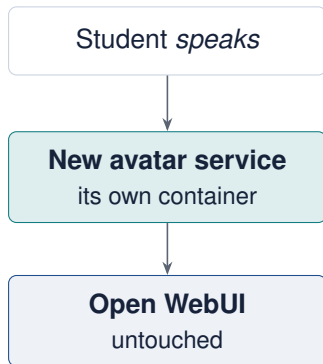
How it bolts on

Student *speaks*

How it bolts on



How it bolts on



Same brain. Same grading. Switch it off and nothing breaks.

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- **Evidence** on whether it makes better advisors

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- Students **talking** to it by the end of term
- **Evidence** on whether it makes better advisors
- A finding we publish **either way**

Come build it with us.